

Case Study Analysis: Ethical Implications of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is one of the world's most influential pieces of technology that is reshaping life as we know it, in every aspect of life. I just bought the new Samsung Galaxy s26 Ultra, which is Samsung's most AI filled phone ever produced, so far, I discovered 3 different AIs on it, and then there's also AIs built into almost every app it's crazy. From automated decision-making to generative texts, images, and code, AI is a part of everything, even education, businesses and healthcare. The case study of AI raises lots of important questions about how it works, what's the benefits of it, and how we are going to monitor the ethical responsibilities when using or designing it. As a current student in Information Science and preparing for a career in technology and working hand and hand with AI, understanding these implications are essential. This essay will analyze the ethical challenges that come about with AI using critical thinking principles, evaluating risks, policy needs, and professional responsibilities.

Today AI is used in almost everything, from automated tasks, analyzing large datasets, personalizing digital experiences, and supporting creative work. Generative AI tools, in particular, can produce human-like writing, images and code, which has changed how students learn and how professionals work. Every day on social media there are millions of videos and images that get posted and, in the comments, people will claim that is AI, but it's extremely hard to tell. In my degree field I've learned to code in GitHub, which uses Copilot to help assist you by giving you suggestions and generating code based off prompts you give it. Research Trends (2023) talked about how these systems also introduce risks related to bias, privacy, transparency, and accountability. Since AI models learn from massive datasets that reflect human behavior, they can reproduce harmful patterns or make decisions that are difficult to explain. A good example of this is when Amazon was testing out AI in the hiring process and it developed bias and discriminatory patterns, so the company had to shut it down. Understanding these issues requires looking beyond the convenience of AI and examining the broader social and ethical consequences that can come about.

One of the biggest ethical concerns mentioned above is bias and fairness. AI often gains biases from the data that is used to make and train them. Research Trends (2023) notes that biased datasets can lead to discriminatory outcomes in areas such as hiring, policing, and education. For example, if an AI model is trained on writing samples from a narrow demographic, it may evaluate or generate content in ways that disadvantage others. Furze (2023) talks about this issue in education, explaining that students may be unfairly judged if AI tools are used to detect "AI-generated writing" or assess originality. These AIs are not always accurate, and their judgements can reinforce inequalities. Critical thinking requires questioning the assumptions behind these tools and recognizing that "objective" algorithms are still shaped by human choices. Me and my friends actually talk all the time how AI punishes smart people

who were trained and learned proper writing etiquette. If you are an excellent writer, you'll almost always get flagged for AI. Throughout my college experience, I've had plenty of classmates that actually tell me that they need to use AI to dumb down their papers, because when they write it themselves, they always get flagged for AI and are tired of having to write a new paper in front of the professor to prove them wrong. It's a very difficult situation to put educators in when it comes to grading papers.

Another big issue comes from privacy and data use. AI systems rely on a crazy amount of data, often collected without users fully understanding what they agreed too and how it'll be used. Generative AI tools store prompts, learn from user inputs, or generate outputs based on patterns from private or copyrighted material. This raises concerns about consent and intellectual property. Furze (2023) argues that educators and institutions must be transparent about how AI tools handle student data, especially when integrated into learning platforms like Canvas. As AI becomes more intertwined with daily life, people need to critically evaluate what information they share and how it may be used.

The last concern I have, that I've also talked about in the other sections, is academic integrity and the future of learning. The AI Assessment Scale (Perkins et al., 2024) proposes a framework for regulating AI use in assignments, ranging from fully prohibited too fully integrated. The scale acknowledges that AI can support learning when used responsibly, but it also warns that overreliance may undermine skill development. This creates a multitude of important questions: Should students be allowed to use AI as a helpful tool to help brainstorm and study but not draft and do their work for them? Should AI be cited as a source? How do we guarantee that that students are still learning the proper skills and tools needed? The most important thing is recognizing that AI is neither harmful nor beneficial, it really just comes to intent, how the user uses it.

With my future career as an information professional, understanding AI is extremely important. In web development and information science, AI is a normal tool for coding assistance, data analysis, and user experience design. However, as a professional I must understand that it is just a tool and every tool has its limits and making sure it is used ethically is very important. This includes evaluating datasets for bias, designing transparent systems, and communicating clearly with users about how AI-driven features work. It also means staying informed about emerging policies and participating in conversations about responsible AI governance.

In conclusion, Artificial Intelligence offers powerful opportunities but also significant ethical challenges. Issues of bias, privacy, transparency, and academic integrity require thoughtful policies and responsible use. The assigned materials highlight the need for frameworks like the AI Assessment Scale and for educators and professionals to approach AI

critically rather than reactively. As AI continues to evolve, information professionals must balance innovation with ethical responsibility, ensuring that technology serves people fairly and transparently. By applying critical thinking, we can better understand these challenges and contribute to a more responsible and equitable digital future.

References

Furze, L. (2023). *Teaching AI ethics*. <https://leonfurze.com/2023/01/26/teaching-ai-ethics/>

Perkins, M., Furze, L., Roe, J., & MacVaugh, J. (2024). *The AI Assessment Scale (AIAS): A framework for ethical integration of generative AI in educational assessment*. *Journal of University Learning and Practice*. <https://doi.org/10.53761/q3azde36>

Research Trends. (2023). *The biggest ethical challenges for artificial intelligence* [Video]. YouTube. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=shZYttzC7Wc>